

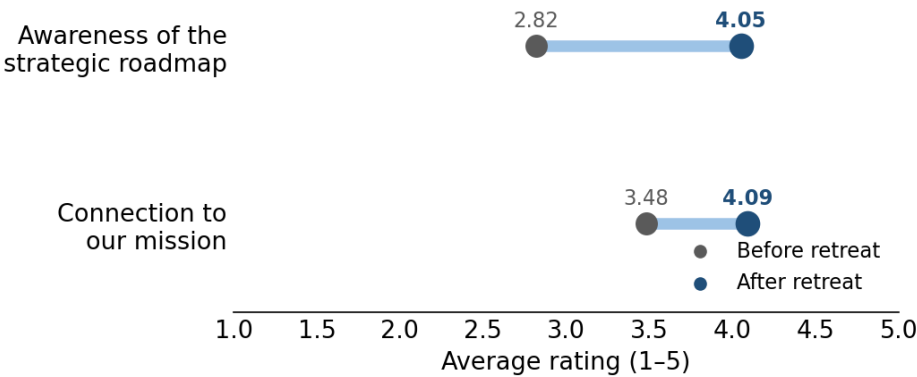
What We Heard at the All-Staff Retreat

A thank-you and a summary of your feedback — and what we’re doing with it

First, thank you. Forty-three of you took the time to complete the post-retreat survey, and 36 wrote thoughtful, open-ended responses. You were honest about what worked and what didn’t — and that honesty is exactly what makes this feedback useful. This is a summary of what you told us and what we are doing in response. Your voice shaped every item on the “what’s next” list.

The Retreat Moved What It Was Meant to Move

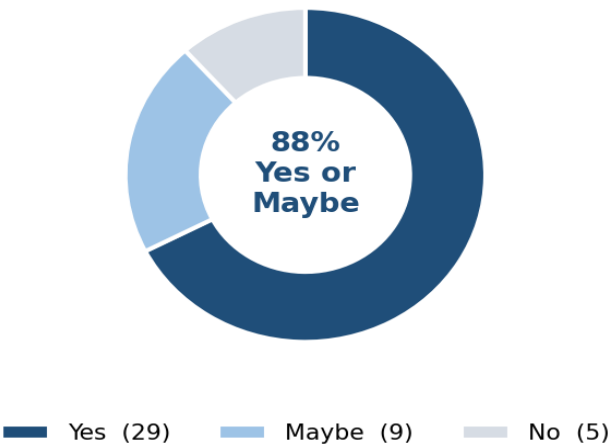
Two questions carried over from the survey we sent before the retreat, so we could see what changed. Both rose — and the biggest jump was in how clearly the strategic roadmap came through.



Connection to our mission rose from 3.48 to 4.09, and awareness of our strategic roadmap rose from 2.82 to 4.05 — the largest single change in the whole survey. Before the retreat, about a third of staff said they didn’t feel informed about the roadmap. After, almost no one did. The roadmap didn’t change; our shared understanding of it did.

Reaching Across Teams

The most important question we asked: after the retreat, do you feel more comfortable reaching out to other teams to collaborate?



Nearly nine in ten of you said Yes or Maybe. That matters, because before the retreat, breaking down silos between our teams was the single most common thing staff asked for. The mixing and table-switching exercises were named again and again as the best part of the day.

“Keep gently forcing us to talk to other people from other departments. We may groan and complain about it, but the way we did it at this retreat actually got us talking and collaborating in small groups with new people. We need more of that.” — A colleague from UCC

What You Told Us Worked

- **Connecting across silos.** The cross-team mixing, table-switching, and case breakouts — named across every department.
- **New connections.** Meeting colleagues face-to-face, several for the first time.
- **Transparency.** The budget and compensation overview — many of you said this was a genuine “aha” moment.
- **The venue.** Highest-rated item in the whole survey.
- **The food.** Rated well, and compared favorably to past retreats.

“I had a few takeaways — it was a wonderful day! One is actually about the importance of getting budget-related things submitted on time. I didn’t realize those monthly amounts are how we get funding for the following year.” — A colleague from FWC

What You Told Us to Change

You were candid, and we heard it clearly. The most common suggestions:

- **The morning ran long on lecture.** Several of you found the morning hard to stay with, and wanted the interactive parts earlier in the day when energy is highest.
- **Connection came too late.** It landed later than it should have — you told us to lead with connection, then move into content.
- **The day ran over.** Running about an hour over cost real things — including, for one of you, a student appointment. That’s on us to fix.
- **Follow-through materials.** Requests for the slides, a written recap, working QR codes on the posters, and published dates for committees and lunch-and-learns.

“Put interaction earlier in the program. Building camaraderie early changes the way we take in information and deepens our connections to both one another and the programming we are discussing.”
— A colleague from CCW

What We’re Doing About It

Your feedback isn’t going into a drawer. Here is what is already underway and what is coming.

Already happening

- **Monthly follow-up meetings** — On the last Friday of each month through September, so we keep talking between retreats and track progress together.
- **Open office hours** — Standing, drop-in time to bring any question, concern, or idea directly — no need to route it through your supervisor.
- **Multiple feedback loops** — Several ways to be heard — “You Asked / We Answered,” anonymous suggestions, monthly meetings, and direct one-on-one access — because different people prefer different channels.
- **Time and autonomy** — Directors have real authority to close for retreats, adjust hours, and give collective time off, plus division-level mental health days.

Coming soon

You asked for	What's coming	When
Slides + a written recap	Posted to the SH&W hub with a one-page “what we said we’d do”	Within 30 days
Working QR codes	Fixed on any reused posters	Within 30 days
Lunch-and-learn dates	A published calendar, first date soon	Within 60 days
Stay connected across teams	Named points of contact per department and structured cross-team time	Ongoing
Keep the roadmap in view	A short, plain-language roadmap update each quarter	Quarterly
A retreat that flows better	Connection first, tighter agenda, ends on time, assigned seats from the start	Next retreat

On the longer horizon

- **Compensation** — A documented salary-equity review, with a written update back to you on what we find and how we respond within available resources.
- **A more connected care model** — We’re building a more connected, continual-care model so support isn’t concentrated in one place — prevention, peer navigation, health literacy, and shared coordination across all of our wellness spaces.
- **Follow-through** — The real measure of trust is whether raising a concern leads to follow-through. That’s the standard we’re holding ourselves to.

One Thing Worth Clarifying

A few of you had questions about the awards and recognition segment. To make it transparent: each director nominates independently for their own department, and the number of nominations is each director’s choice — not a division limit. If your team’s count looked different from another’s, that reflects director discretion, not how much your work is valued. We’ll say this up front next time.

Keep Talking to Us

This retreat was a start, not a finish. The monthly meetings, office hours, and feedback channels are all open, and we mean it. If something here resonates — or if we missed something — bring it. You already showed us that when you speak up, it shapes what happens next.

With gratitude, Thank you for your honesty, your energy, and the care you bring to our students and to each other. This is our division getting stronger, together.

Dr. Sherrá L. Watkins

Associate Vice President for Student Health & Wellness